



As we wrap up 2024, the desktop processor market has delivered yet another year of impressive innovation and competition. AMD has firmly established itself as a leader, with its Zen 5 architecture-based processors continuing to push the envelope in performance and efficiency. The industry is also seeing increasing emphasis on AI capabilities, with both AMD and Intel making strides in integrating dedicated accelerators into their processors. Intel with its Core Ultra series desktop processors also made huge strides on the power efficiency front and did away with Hyper-Threading and instead prioritised adding more actual cores. And while we wait with bated breath to see what the next year has in store, let's take a look at this year's winners.

Winner: AMD Ryzen 7 9800X3D

AMD's Ryzen 7 9800X3D has secured the top spot in 2024's Zero1 Awards, excelling across gaming, productivity, and power efficiency benchmarks. The processor's standout feature is its enhanced 3D V-Cache technology, which dramatically boosts gaming performance. This improvement allows the 9800X3D to handle even the most demanding titles with ease, surpassing its predecessors and competitors alike. In productivity tasks, the Ryzen 7 9800X3D shows a consistent edge. This processor's power efficiency also deserves special mention; AMD has managed to maintain a competitive TDP while delivering unparalleled performance. Although



AMD Ryzen 5 9600X
Price: ₹23,790

Intel's offerings still hold a slight advantage in select single-threaded applications, the Ryzen 7 9800X3D's balanced performance and innovation make it this year's clear winner.

Runner-Up: AMD Ryzen 9 9950X

The AMD Ryzen 9 9950X claims the runner-up spot, excelling in multi-threaded workloads. The fact that a higher-tier Ryzen 9 processor is coming in second place behind the upper-mid tier Ryzen 7 X3D processor shows how much 3D V-Cache is helping. Built on AMD's refined Zen 5 microarchitecture, the processor boasts exceptional performance in content creation and productivity benchmarks. Despite its raw power, the Ryzen 9 9950X doesn't quite match the efficiency of the Ryzen 7 9800X3D, particularly in gaming. The lack of 3D V-Cache technology, a feature reserved for the 9800X3D, makes it less appealing to gamers seeking optimal performance. Nevertheless, for professionals in need of heavy multitasking capabilities and accelerated rendering, the Ryzen 9 9950X remains an excellent choice.



AMD Ryzen 9 9950X
Price: ₹57,600

Desktop Processors

The evolution continues



AMD Ryzen 7 9800X3D
Price: ₹49,999

Best Buy: AMD Ryzen 5 9600X

For those looking for value without compromising on performance, the AMD Ryzen 5 9600X emerges as the Best Buy for 2024. Featuring six cores and 12 threads, this processor provides a fantastic balance of price and performance, making it ideal for gamers and content creators on a budget. The Ryzen 5 9600X shines in 1080p gaming which is where most of the gamers are, thus, offering impressive value for money owing to high frame rates and smooth gameplay. It also performs admirably in productivity tasks, handling photo and video editing workloads with ease. Its competitive pricing and efficiency solidify its position as the go-to processor for budget-conscious buyers.

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